

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Smoking in Public Places - What's Your Opinion?



Learning Outcome

Express duty, advice, willingness, or intention to do something in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What issues in your community do you feel strongly about? Why?
- Do you think smoking should be allowed in public spaces? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

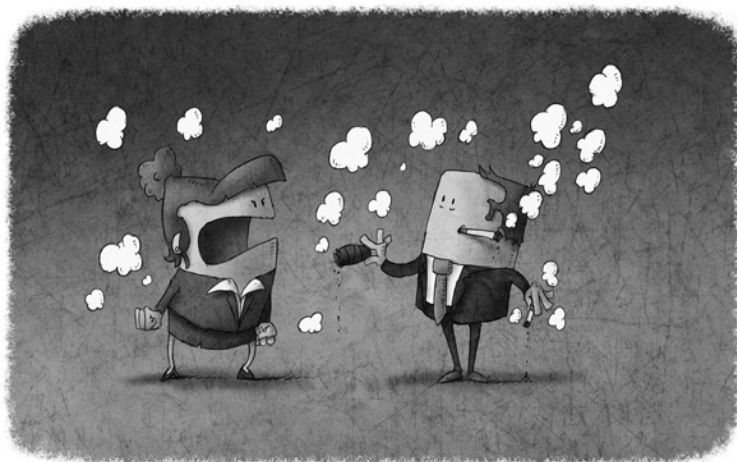
- I can write an opinion paragraph about social issues.
- I can write about beliefs, opinions and moral or personal dilemmas.
- I can express duty and advice in written form.





Let's Explore!

Do you have an opinion on smoking in public places? What is this author's opinion?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Smoking is a hazardous, destructive habit that should not be allowed in public places. Firstly, it is well-documented that smoking leads to a significant number of health-related issues. Cigarettes contain toxic carcinogens that are directly linked to cancer. Why should we be encouraging people to smoke in the first place when it is costing taxpayers millions of dollars each year in medical bills? Also, studies have also shown that second-hand smoke is extremely harmful. Our lungs should not be polluted for the sake of catering to someone's selfishness.

Secondly, public spaces are exactly that - places meant for everyone. That being the case, to deliberately cloud the air frequented by the non-smoking public with poisonous emissions is simply wrong. I think the rights of non-smoking citizens ought to take precedence over a few stick puffers. People should have the right to go to malls, restaurants, coffee shops, book stores, and not have to worry about ending up fighting lung cancer. Shouldn't we as a society have the collective right to breathe clean air, regardless of location?

Finally, smokers have a responsibility to the environment. Pollution is a major concern facing our planet. Smokers do nothing to decrease our negative impact on our surroundings. In fact, cigarette butts often litter public areas and are caught in the drains leading to our waterways. I firmly believe that their reckless, deleterious behavior affects everyone and is counter productive in our fight against global warming. We, as a community must take a stand and pressure our elected officials to restrict smoking in all public places. For those smokers who may believe it is their right to smoke; I would say yes, you do. Smokers ought to quit, stay home or use a nicotine patch. It's as simple as that!





Let's Practice!

Can you write about your beliefs, opinions and dilemmas in a structured fashion*?

*"Fashion" in this sentence means style or way.

Instructions: Write your opinion about the current government in Colombia. Use the words in the Word Bank to connect your ideas.

Word Bank

Firstly / Secondly / Finally / In fact / Because / So / Since / Therefore



Let's Practice!

Can you write about your beliefs, opinions and dilemmas in a structured fashion?

Instructions: Match the first part of the sentence from Column A with the last part of the sentence in Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Smoking is a hazardous, destructive
2. Firstly, it is well-documented that smoking leads
3. Cigarettes contain toxic carcinogens
4. Secondly, I think public spaces are exactly that –
5. Finally, I believe smokers have
6. In fact, cigarette butts often litter public areas and

COLUMN B

- a) habit that should not be allowed in public places.
- b) a responsibility to the environment. Pollution is a major concern facing our planet.
- c) are caught in drains leading to our waterways.
- d) that are directly linked to cancer.
- e) places meant for everyone.
- f) to a significant number of health-related issues.





Extension Activity

What are your views on international challenges?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research social issues that another country is currently facing.
- Choose an issue you feel strongly about.
- Write a 180-200-word opinion paragraph based on your notes.
- Express an opinion and support it with details.
- Support your opinion with reasons, examples or facts.
- Use transition words to connect your ideas.
- Express advice using modals.
- Use a variety of sentence types and lengths.
- When complete, read your opinion paragraph to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research social issues that other countries are facing.

☐ ☐

I write an opinion paragraph about a social issue.

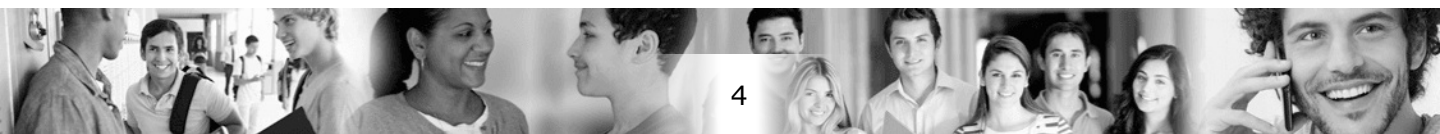
☐ ☐

I read my opinion paragraph to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- precedence** (noun): the condition of being more important than something or someone else and therefore coming or being dealt with first
e.g. The rights of non-smoking citizens ought to take precedence over a few stick puffers.
- carcinogen** (noun): a substance that can cause cancer
e.g. Cigarettes contain toxic carcinogens that are directly linked to cancer.
- collective** (adjective): shared or done by a group of people
e.g. Shouldn't we, as a society, have the collective right to breathe clean air, regardless of location?
- deleterious** (adjective): damaging or harmful
e.g. The deleterious effects of smoking can be seen in our communities.
- reckless** (adjective): not showing proper concern about the possible bad results of your actions
e.g. Their reckless behavior affects everyone and is counterproductive in our fight against global warming.
- nicotine patch** (noun): a type of small covering worn on the arm that controls the addiction to the chemicals found in tobacco
e.g. Your choices are to quit, stay home or use a nicotine patch.
- cigarette butt** (noun): the end part of a cigarette that is not smoked
e.g. In fact, cigarette butts often litter public areas and are caught in drains leading to our waterways.





Learning Points

How to Write an Opinion Paragraph

An opinion paragraph states a viewpoint and then provides specific examples to support that view.

You structure an opinion paragraph by clearly stating your opinion at the beginning of the paragraph.

Then, support your opinion with reasons, examples or facts.

Your response must be clear and organized.

Use a concluding sentence or two, to summarize your argument and restate your opinion.

Adding modals to your opinion paragraph can make your paragraph more persuasive.

should	could	can
ought to	have to	must

Words like *therefore*, *because*, *since* and *so* can connect ideas.

For example:

*There is a connection between second-hand smoke and lung cancer, **therefore**, public areas should be smoke free.*

*Smoking in public areas should be banned **because** we all have a right to clear air.*

***Since** we live in a global community, we need to maintain a healthy environment for anyone.*

*The medical facts are clear **so** there should not be any reason to argue against the proposal.*

Examples:

- *Our lungs should not be polluted for the sake of catering to someone's selfishness.*
- *Shouldn't we as a society have the collective right to breathe clean air, regardless of location?*
- *We as a community must take a stand and pressure our elected officials to restrict smoking in all public places.*



Learning Points

Writing Tip: Using Modals in Opinion Paragraphs

You can use a variety of modals in your writing to express the different degrees of certainty or modality of your opinions or arguments. It is important to be as clear as you can when you discuss your views on a particular subject.

Refer to the chart for a summary of modals you can use in your writing, and an example of how to structure your sentences using the modals. (Punctuation is important.)

Certainty	Modal	Examples
Strong	<i>will, must</i>	<i>It will be clearly demonstrated that there is a connection between smoking and poor health. It must be seen in the right context.</i>
Moderate	<i>should, would, can, ought to</i>	<i>These ideas ought to be shared to provide health and wellness in society. People should take responsibility for their health.</i>
Tentative (weak)	<i>may, might, could</i>	<i>It may be the case that some people are not prepared to hear the truth. It might be true that gentle persuasion is necessary.</i>

Take a look at some examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Our lungs should not be polluted for the sake of catering to someone's selfishness .*
- *The rights of non-smoking citizens ought to take precedence over a few stick puffers.*
- *We as a community must take a stand and pressure our elected officials to restrict smoking in all public places.*

